UX Community

Course Work

Voting Starter Kit

A fast, multi-channel starter kit that motivates and enables new immigrants to vote.

View Prototype

Overview

This project tackles low participation in New Zealand local elections by designing a short, multi-channel "starter kit" (social media swipe cards, a folded brochure, and a year-round website) that motivates and enables new immigrants to understand, share, and act. I led mixed qualitative and quantitative planning, framed the problem with data, and delivered test-backed content strategies and prototypes that connect abstract policies to everyday life. Outcomes include refined principles, a motivation-driven design strategy, and hi-fi deliverables tested for clarity and trust.

Client
MUXD

Timeline
6 Weeks

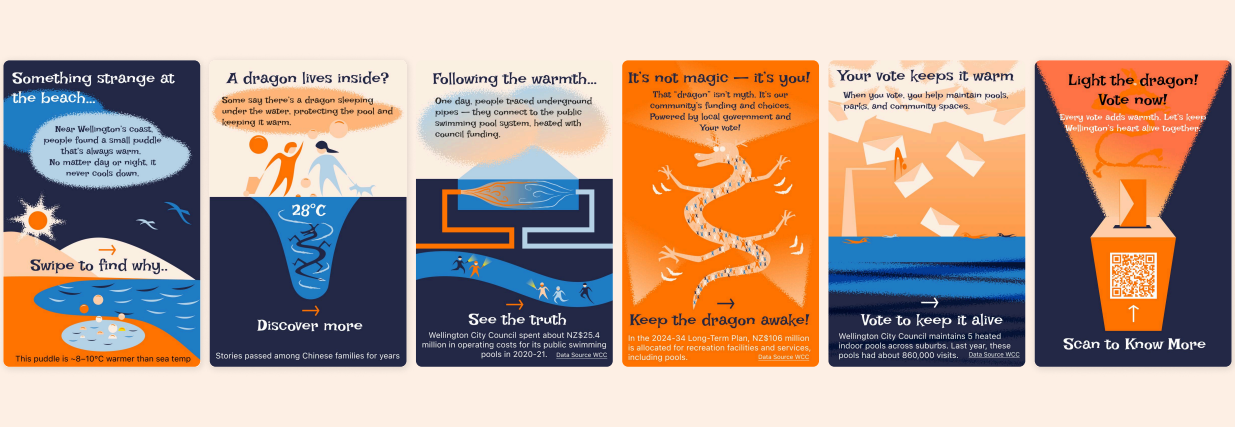
Role
Research & Analysis
UX/UI Design
Usability Testing

Tools
Figma
Miro

Team
4 UX Designers

Skills

Mixed Methods Research · Information Architecture · UI Design · Illustration · Storytelling · Workshop


Something strange at the beach...
Swipe to find why..
A dragon lives inside?
28°C
Discover more
Following the warmth...
See the truth
It's not magic — it's you!
Keep the dragon awake!
Your vote keeps it warm
Vote to keep it alive
Light the dragon! Vote now!
Scan to Know More

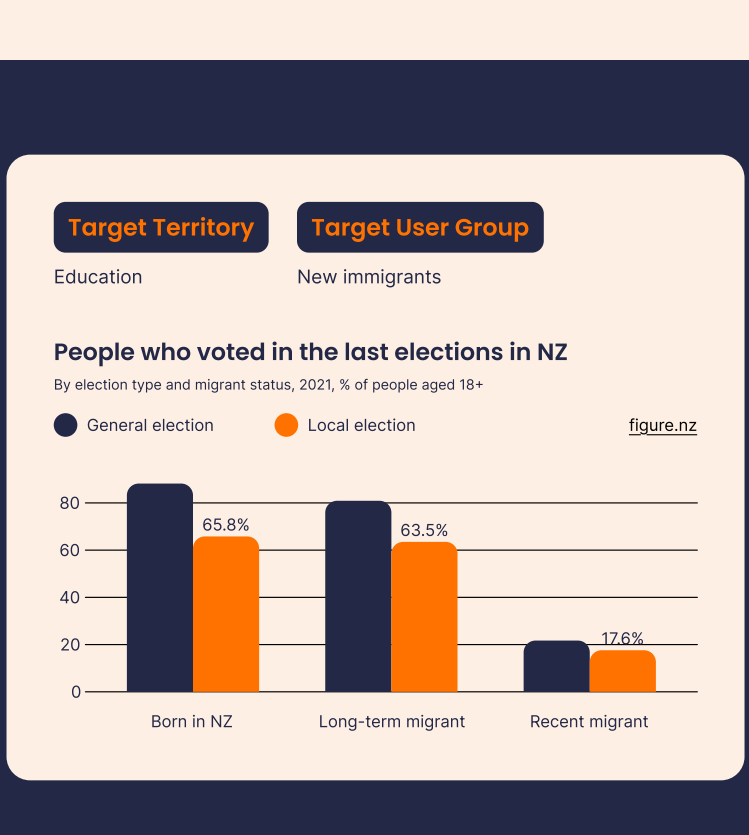
Problem

Why local election outreach misses new immigrants

Despite the daily impact of local government services, turnout has fallen; new immigrants in particular show very low participation compared with NZ-born and long-term residents. Information is scattered, often abstract, and not delivered through channels people actually use; newcomers struggle with confidence, relevance, and trust.

Target Territory
Education

Target User Group
New immigrants



Solution

Motivate first, then lower effort across three touchpoints

We created a multi-platform approach aligned to the election cycle, Social media swipe cards that lead with relatable, visual stories and short actions. A folded brochure explaining "Why vote" and "How to vote," designed for family contexts. A Voting Information Portal (website) that centralises basics, links official sources, and supports multi-language and accessibility.

Swipe Cards
Voting Season

Folded Brochure
Start Point

Website
Longterm

Outcome

Tested principles and hi-fi deliverables ready for outreach

High-fidelity cards, brochure, and website aligned to refined principles; a content calendar/plan for social rollout; and evaluation paths (pre-launch comprehension; post-launch engagement metrics and follow-up interviews).

Something strange at the beach...
Near Wellington's coast, people found a small puddle that's always warm. No matter day or night, it never cools down.
Swipe to find why..
This puddle is ~8–10°C warmer than sea temp

Feedback

Clear structure, strong testing, and well-documented insights with consistent, accessible design.The final outcomes are strong, well-researched, and show a holistic approach to democratic engagement.

"Final design outcomes are rigorous and reflect a solid research and design process; the three media work together across the journey."

"Social cards illustrations and colours are well chosen; the card narrative uses visual storytelling effectively."

"Accessibility considerations and guidelines plus implementation plans show care for diverse users."

"Research and process were detailed and rigorous; strong team management and large-scale delivery; flexible reframing after desk research; interviews well explained and method choices justified."

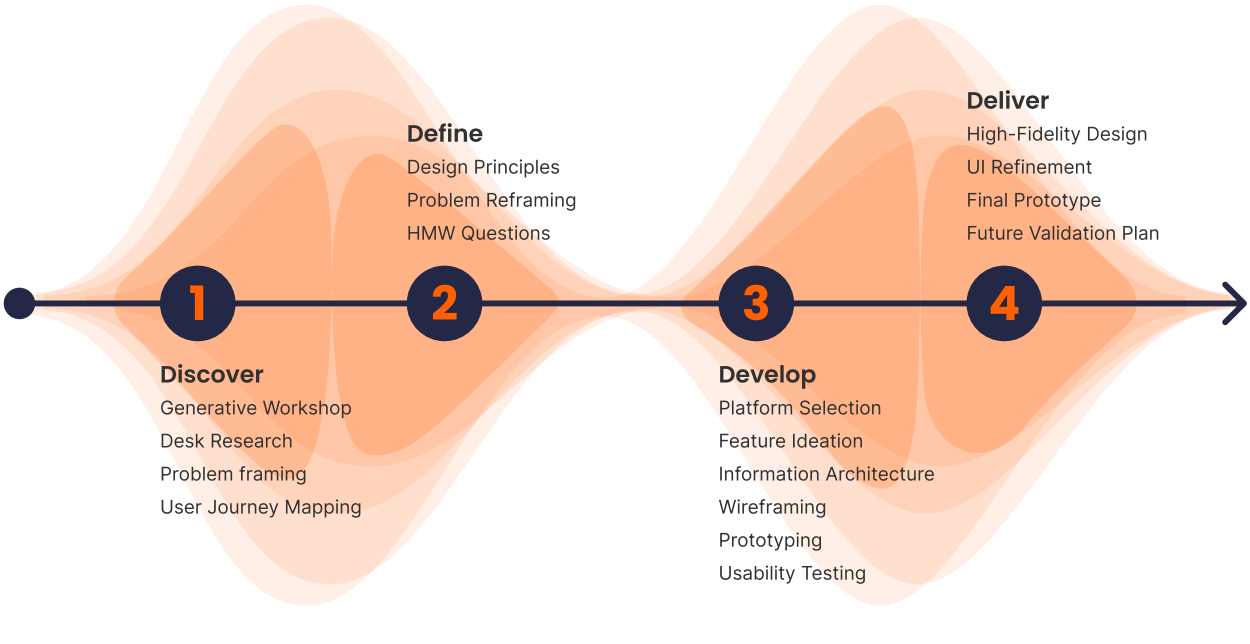
"Design process and testing are clear; concept → testing → refinement of cards and brochure are easy to follow; website testing would have helped, but the final quality is high."

Course Feedback

Design Process

From evidence to motivation—turning abstract civics into clear, doable actions

We focused on real barriers for new immigrants—low confidence, scattered information, and weak trust—then narrowed to new immigrants and set four communication principles: social-first, plain/visual language, educational/credible tone, and everyday relevance. From this, we built a motivation-plus-ability system (swipe cards, brochure, website) and iterated—simplifying visuals, adding credible data, pacing cards as small chapters, and linking CTAs to the portal—so the kit gets attention, builds trust, and makes the next step obvious.



1 **Discover**
Generative Workshop
Desk Research
Problem framing
User Journey Mapping

2 **Define**
Design Principles
Problem Reframing
HMW Questions

3 **Develop**
Platform Selection
Feature Ideation
Information Architecture
Wireframing
Prototyping
Usability Testing

4 **Deliver**
High-Fidelity Design
UI Refinement
Final Prototype
Future Validation Plan

Discover

Workshop mapping revealed outreach, understanding, and action barriers; opportunity areas were grouped into system vs education problems. Data pointed to new immigrants as an underserved group; goals centred on motivation, clarifying process, simplifying content, and centralising information access.

Background

Local government delivers everyday essentials—clean water, rubbish collection, public transport and roads, dog control, parks, libraries, and disaster preparedness—yet local election turnout has declined from over 50% in 1989 to around 41–42% today, with the steepest drops in rural areas and participation falling nationwide. To respond, this project examines the issue from multiple angles to pinpoint a clear focus and develop a practical design solution that makes local civic information more engaging, relevant, and actionable.

Initial desk research

Turnout is undermined by overloaded/unclear materials, new immigrants' language/process barriers, youth info gaps/alienation and practical obstacles, and system constraints (postal voting limits, hard-to-access candidate info) that erode ease and trust.

DF01
Communication overload
Current voting materials suffer from information overload, unclear messaging, and mismatched channels, reducing clarity and reach.

DF02
New immigrants' barriers
Newcomers face language hurdles, process confusion, and competing life priorities, which suppress confidence and participation.

DF03
Youth disengagement
Young voters experience information gaps, political alienation, and practical obstacles that prevent them from voting.

DF04
System limitations
Structural issues—postal voting constraints and poorly accessible candidate information—undermine ease of use and trust.

Generative Workshop

In the workshop we mapped the voter journey (Outreach → Understanding → Action) and surfaced core barriers: information not reaching diverse channels/outdated addresses, policies feeling irrelevant or unclear with youth under-represented, and inconvenient logistics plus confusing rules. We clustered opportunities into five areas (system, digital solution, information gap, education, overlooked) and set two priority groups—young people and ethnic minorities—to guide the next phases.

Opportunity Areas

- 01 System Problem
- 02 Digital Solution
- 03 Information Gap
- 04 Education
- 05 Overload

Target User Groups

Young People · Ethnic Minorities

Design scope

Building on the workshop, we grouped five opportunity areas into two themes—system vs education—and chose education as the primary lever (the human, addressable root of many barriers). Using GSS data (local turnout 17.6% for new immigrants vs 65.8% NZ-born and 63.5% long-term immigrants), we narrowed the target to new immigrants (esp. young families) and set the objective to design clear, relatable, multi-channel civic education that motivates participation and lowers effort.

New Immigrants · Education

Goals & Objectives

The goal of this project is to help new immigrants better understand and participate in local elections.

Build Motivation
Help users understand why participating in local elections matters, how local government impacts their daily lives, and why their voices count.

Clarify the Process
Help users understand how to participate by clearly explaining each step of the voting process.

Simplify Voting Content
Make complex voting information easier to understand by using clear language and explanations tailored for new immigrants.

Streamline Information Access
Organise and centralise scattered information so users can find what they need quickly without jumping between multiple websites.

Initial Problem Statement

How might we break the 'don't know—don't care—don't vote' cycle through civic education so participation becomes easier?

Assumptions

We captured assumptions on motivation, belonging, plain/multilingual content, peer/community influence, and small rewards to test later.

01 If new immigrants understand how voting benefits them, they will feel more motivated to participate.

02 When immigrants feel valued as citizens, voting seems more meaningful and worthwhile.

03 Clear, simple, and multilingual educational resources can help new immigrants understand voting and build confidence.

04 If friends or family members vote, newcomers are more likely to follow their example.

05 When community leaders or influencers talk about voting, newcomers are more likely to participate.

06 Explaining voting through stories or community workshops works better than just giving brochures.

07 Small rewards, like a reusable shopping bag or a card holder, can make voting feel rewarding and reinforce the habit.

08 If candidates and officials highlight the importance of democracy, newcomers may feel more motivated to vote.

09 When society gives positive feedback about voting, newcomers are more likely to maintain the habit.

Define

We narrowed scope through secondary and primary research, synthesised findings and insights, reframed the problem for young families, and set four principles: multi-channel (social-first), plain/visual language, educational tone for trust, and everyday relevance.

Secondary research

Desk evidence shows new immigrants skew to young families (ages 30–39 and 0–19), suggesting content must fit busy schedules and support parent–child co-learning. Source-country profiles (e.g., India, Philippines, China) point to multilingual, culturally sensitive communication and community-based approaches to build trust and relevance.

SF01
Young-family rhythm
Content should be short, structured, and easy to access, aligned to working adults with children.

SF02
Multilingual reach
Prioritise Hindi, Tagalog, and Chinese alongside English to broaden coverage and reduce language friction.

SF03
Family co-learning
Use simple visuals + light interactivity (e.g., games, step cards) so parents and children can learn together.

SF04
Cultural tone
Adopt neutral, respectful messaging and local community cues to increase approachability and trust.

SF05
Channel selection
Design for social-first distribution while keeping printable/offline formats for households with limited device use.

SF05
Everyday anchors
Tie topics to daily life (transport, housing, cost of living) to make abstract policies immediately relevant.

Primary Research

Four interviews (new or settling immigrants) probed confusion points, what would make content engaging/meaningful, and spontaneous sharing behaviours—turning abstract goals into concrete communication choices.

Findings

People rely on social media and posters but rarely seek details; policy slogans are unclear; eligibility is uncertain; long text is demotivating; distrust is common; personal relevance drives attention; and information volume is low.

IF01
Social channels dominate
People get info mainly via social media or local posters.

IF02
Curious yet inactive
Interest exists but doesn't translate to action.

IF03
Slogans ≠ clarity
Candidate slogans/policies are hard to understand.

IF04
Eligibility confusion
Many don't know if they're eligible to vote.

IF05
Text overload
Complex/abstract wording reduces motivation to read.

IF06
Low trust
Promotion feels like advertising; participation seems meaningless.

IF07
Personal relevance wins
Cost of living, housing, transport draw attention.

IF08
Information scarcity
People haven't received enough local election info.

Insights

Keep content short, visual, and real-life; build trust with clear answers, credible sources, and professional design; avoid overload with small, actionable steps and "know more" paths; social/community context and friendly tone matter.

- **01** Information channels influence engagement
- **02** Lack of confidence and understanding hinders participation
- **03** Lack of trust affects motivation
- **04** Social and emotional factors drive participation
- **05** Personal relevance drives attention

Problem Reframing

Bridge: Based on research, we focused the challenge on young families: make local election information clearer, engaging, and easier to share so newcomers feel confident and motivated.

How might we help new immigrants, especially young families, break the cycle of "don't know — don't care — don't vote" by making local election information clearer, more engaging, and easier to share, so they feel confident and motivated to participate?

Design Principles

From divergent thinking + interviews, we prioritized: Transparency, Clarity, Efficiency, Accessibility, Supportiveness, Inclusiveness—with explicit language about visibility, simplicity, quickness, guidance, fairness, and diversity.

Prioritise social media and adopt a multi-channel communication strategy
Election information should be distributed through multiple channels to maximise reach, with social media as the primary focus. To increase engagement, content should be visually appealing and tailored to the formats and interaction patterns of different platforms.

Use plain and visual language
Voting information should be explained in everyday language so that users can understand it more easily. Prioritising visual communication can enhance comprehension, especially for users from diverse language backgrounds.

Adopt an educational rather than promotional tone
The communication should focus on educating rather than campaigning, aiming to build trust and encourage curiosity. Information should be presented objectively, emphasising learning and empowerment rather than persuasion.

Connect policies to everyday life
Abstract policies should be made tangible and relatable by linking them to everyday scenarios, making voting information more meaningful to new immigrants. Narrative techniques and relatable examples can play a key role in bridging the gap between policies and daily experiences.

Develop

We shifted from campaign "stimulus" to a motivation cycle ("I Know → I Care → I Vote"), then ideated and built mid-fi prototypes for cards, brochure, and website. Usability testing refined messages, tone, visuals, and interaction; principles were tightened; hi-fi updates added credible data and platform-consistent colours.

Design Strategy

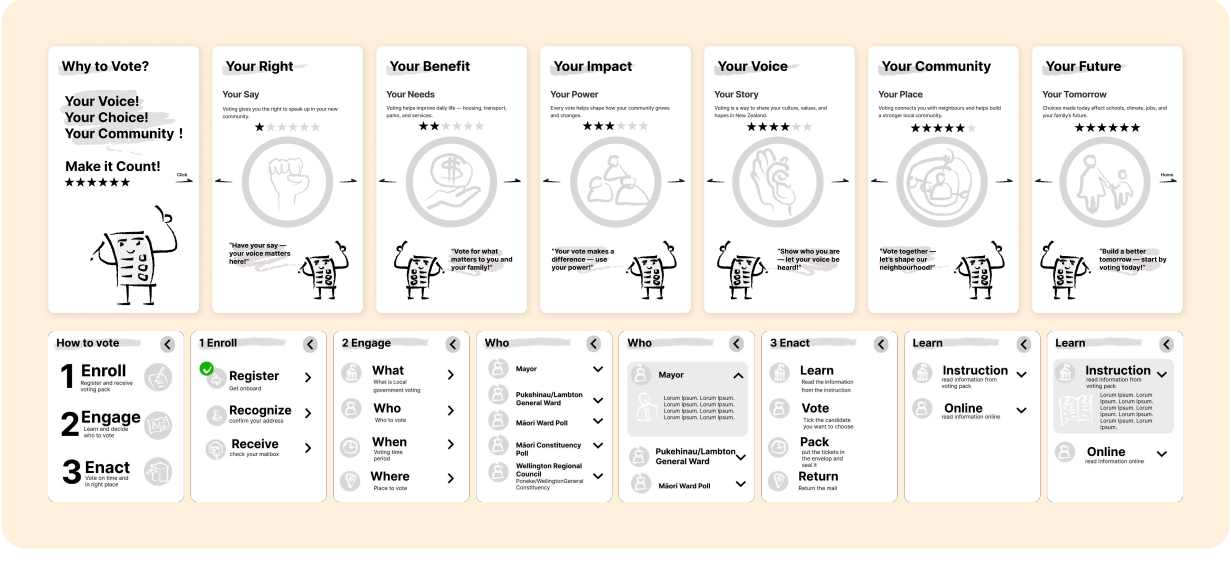
Short/Mid/Long-term roadmap

Short-term: make unfamiliar info relatable via social cards/brochure; Mid-term: reduce process friction via website; Long-term: build trust/belonging with a settlement support portal concept.

Phase	Objective	Design Outcome	Evaluation Plan
Short Term	Make unfamiliar voting information relatable for new immigrants.	Launch social media swipe cards for election season and a folded brochure for residency/public offices.	Pre-launch comprehension/ comparison testing; post-launch track engagement metrics and run follow-up interviews.
Mid Term	Make accessing and using voting information easy and stress-free.	Ship a year-round Voting Information Portal with flat IA, key flows, and links to official sources.	Pre-launch tree testing + mid-fi task usability; post-launch monitor traffic/completions and conduct interviews.
Long Term	Build trust and belonging through everyday civic participation beyond election seasons.	Prototype a Settlement Support Portal to bridge everyday information gaps and connect people to services.	Pre-launch co-design + tree/ usability testing; post-launch track site metrics and run follow-ups.

Ideation

From interviews, we found motivation matters more than information — people who want to vote will find the "how" themselves. So we focused on "Why vote" and explored different ways of telling the story.



User Journey

During election season, social swipe cards hook curiosity, the folded brochure clarifies why/how, and the portal's four-step flow carries users from hesitant to confident to action.
Between seasons, everyday topics + community updates sustain trust and belonging, while short visuals, small optional steps, clear CTAs, and multi-language/accessibility keep friction low so the next step is always obvious.

Timeframe	Key Moment	Goal	Feelings	Design Support
Short-term (Election season)	See cards; tap brochure/ portal	Spark interest; quick clarity	Curious → willing	Short, visual cards; "know more" links; QR to portal
Mid-term (During voting window)	Plan action	Reduce effort; step-by-step help	Anxious → confident	Website "How to vote" steps; multi-language; search
Long-term (Off-season)	Everyday civic topics	Build trust/belonging	Neutral → connected	Ongoing stories; settlement info concept (future)
Identity milestone	Gain residency	Onboard basics	Unsure → oriented	Brochure "Why/How"; family-friendly interaction

Information Architecture

Homepage routes directly to About Voting (why/who/when) and How to Vote (step by step), plus search, FAQ, language, and accessibility—keeping depth shallow and labels clear.

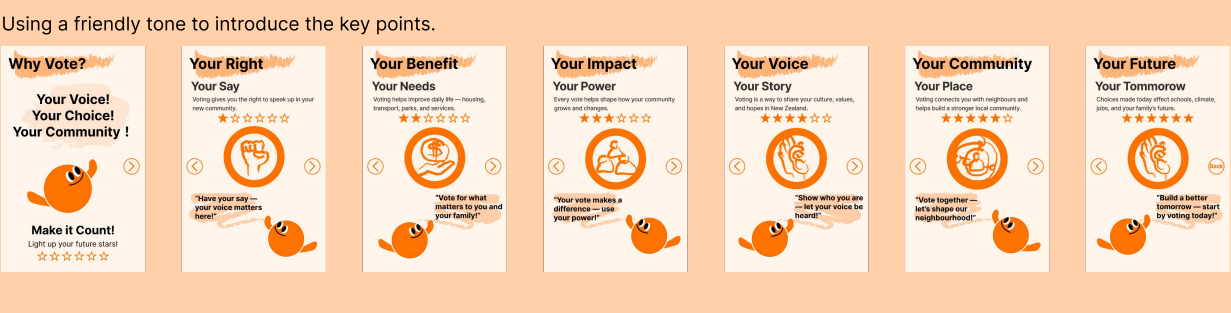
Homepage
- About voting
  - Why it matters
  - Impact
  - Real stories
  - Who to vote
  - When & Where
- How to vote
  - Enrol to vote
  - Voting pack
  - Fill in voting pater
- Support
  - FAQ
  - Language
  - Accessibility
- Search

Prototype

We refined three narrative styles into mid-fi prototypes to prepare for usability testing.

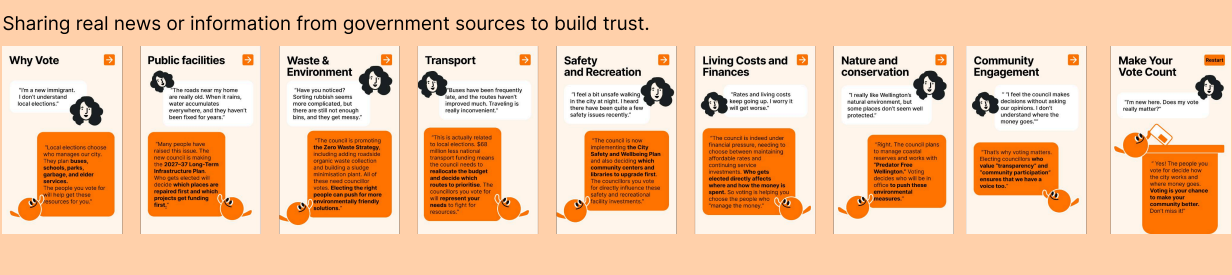
Comic style

Using a friendly tone to introduce the key points.



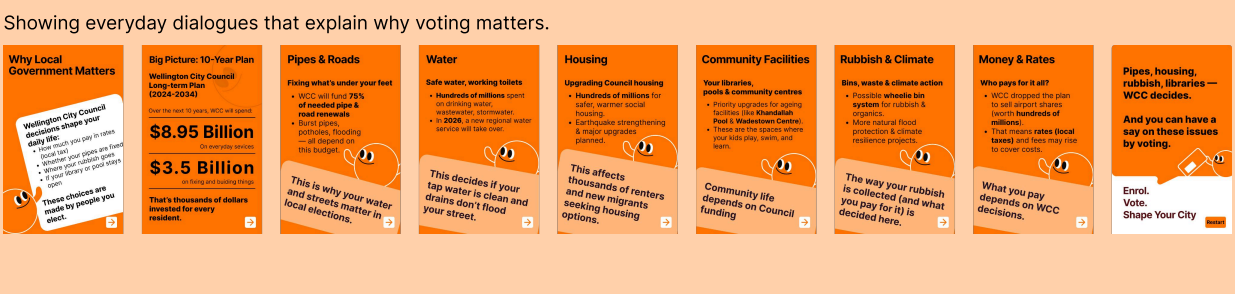
News style

Sharing real news or information from government sources to build trust.



Neighbour style

Showing everyday dialogues that explain why voting matters.


Why Local Government Matters
Big Picture: 10-Year Plan
$8.95 Billion
$3.5 Billion
Pipes & Roads
Water
Housing
Community Facilities
Rubbish & Climate
Money & Rates
Pipes, housing, rubbish, libraries — WCC decides.
Enrol. Vote. Shape Your City

Usability test

Comparative and Comprehensive test

Four participants assessed clarity/engagement; we probed which elements best communicate voting's importance and how visuals aid newcomers.

Findings

Short text + intuitive images; real-life scenarios; eye-catching covers; direct answers + credible sources; and small actionable steps.

UF01 Shorter text and intuitive images help build clarity, while harsh colours could damage readability.

UF02 Real-life scenarios and narratives make people feel more relatable and willing to engage.

UF03 Social media posts should have an eye-catching cover; otherwise people won't bother to read.

UF04 Direct answer, clear design, and solid data help build trust.

UF05 Small, actionable steps lower the threshold of participation.

Insights

Make content short and visual with real-life anchors; use reliable sources and professional tone; deliver one small step at a time with optional deeper info.

- **01** Keep content short, visual, and based on real life
- **02** Build trust with clear answers, real sources, and professional design
- **03** Don't overload people — give small steps and let them choose

Principle refinement

We tightened principles to emphasise channel fit, readability, neutral/credible tone, and real-life relevance across all materials.

01
Prioritise social media with content that fits the medium
Use social media as a main way to connect with people and stay relevant. Match the content to how people use each platform — fast, visual, and easy to engage with.

02
Use plain and visual language to make information accessible
Speak in simple, everyday language and use visuals to help people from different backgrounds quickly understand and stay interested.

03
Build trust through a credible tone and clear information
Trust comes from being clear, neutral, and using reliable sources. Avoid overly emotional or playful styles that might seem less trustworthy.

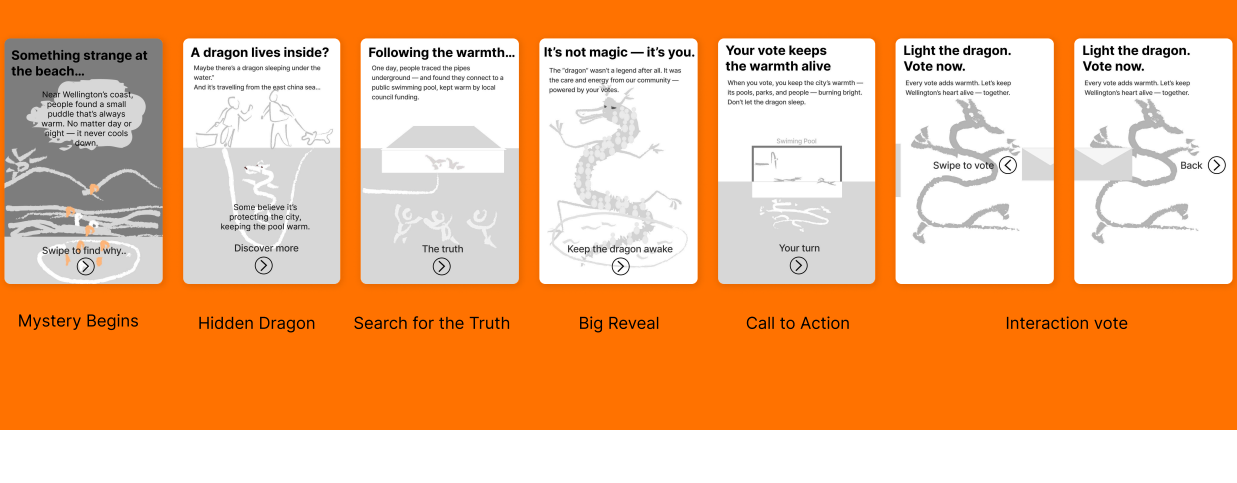
04
Make policies tangible through real-life scenarios
Policies shouldn't feel abstract. Show how they relate to daily life like transport, housing, or cost of living, so people can see how local decisions affect them.

Prototype Refinement

Social media works best with short, attention-grabbing content. Instead of telling one big story all at once, we broke it into smaller chapters and released them at the right moments. For example, sharing stories about public transportation on Mondays, and stories about swimming pool on Weekends.

Suspenseful Story

To increase attention on social media, we applied the refined principles through a mystery-style narrative inspired by a local legend. Using swimming pools as an example, we created a set of swipe cards that make information more engaging.


Something strange at the beach...
A dragon lives inside?
Following the warmth...
It's not magic — it's you.
Your vote keeps the warmth alive
Light the dragon. Vote now.
Light the dragon. Vote now.

Mystery Begins · Hidden Dragon · Search for the Truth · Big Reveal · Call to Action · Interaction vote

Deliver

Final concept includes social cards (hi-fi narrative set with data and CTA), folded brochure (refined readability and UX writing), and a website (IA, flows, key screens); plus a content calendar for election/off-season posts.

Design system

We aligned colour with NZ voting palette (orange primary, blue secondary), used Inter for reading and a playful accent font for social cards, kept icons minimal and model-led, and adopted simple, supportive illustration styles—backed by contrast and hierarchy specs.

Typography

Playful accent font (e.g., Irish Grover) for social cards; Inter for brochure/website body to maximise clarity.

Primary
Irish Grover

Secondary
Inter

Iconography

Outlined, minimal icons that match common mental models and aid quick scanning.

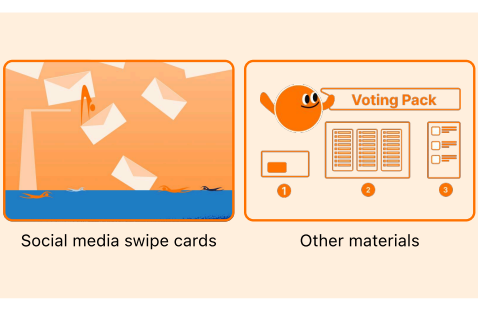
Colour

Primary orange (from official voting site cues) + blue secondary to build contrast and recognition in cards and site.

#FF6000 · #FFD0AA · #FEF0E4 · #B6D3E7 · #207DC6 · #242947

Illustration

For swipe cards, simple illustrations with solid colour blocks; elsewhere, simple lines and basic shapes as functional aids (not decoration).



Social media swipe cards · Other materials

Accessibility

Color contrast

Main body text meets AAA contrast; supporting text meets AA.

✓ AAA (Large text)
✓ AA (Normal text)
Text #000000
Surface #FF6000

✓ AAA (Normal text)
Text #FFFFFF
Surface #000000

✓ AAA (Normal text)
Text #000000
Surface #FFFFFF

Text Hierarchy

Headings: H1 48px, H2 32px, H3 24px; body ≥16px (spec baseline 24px for this site) to ensure legibility and contrast.

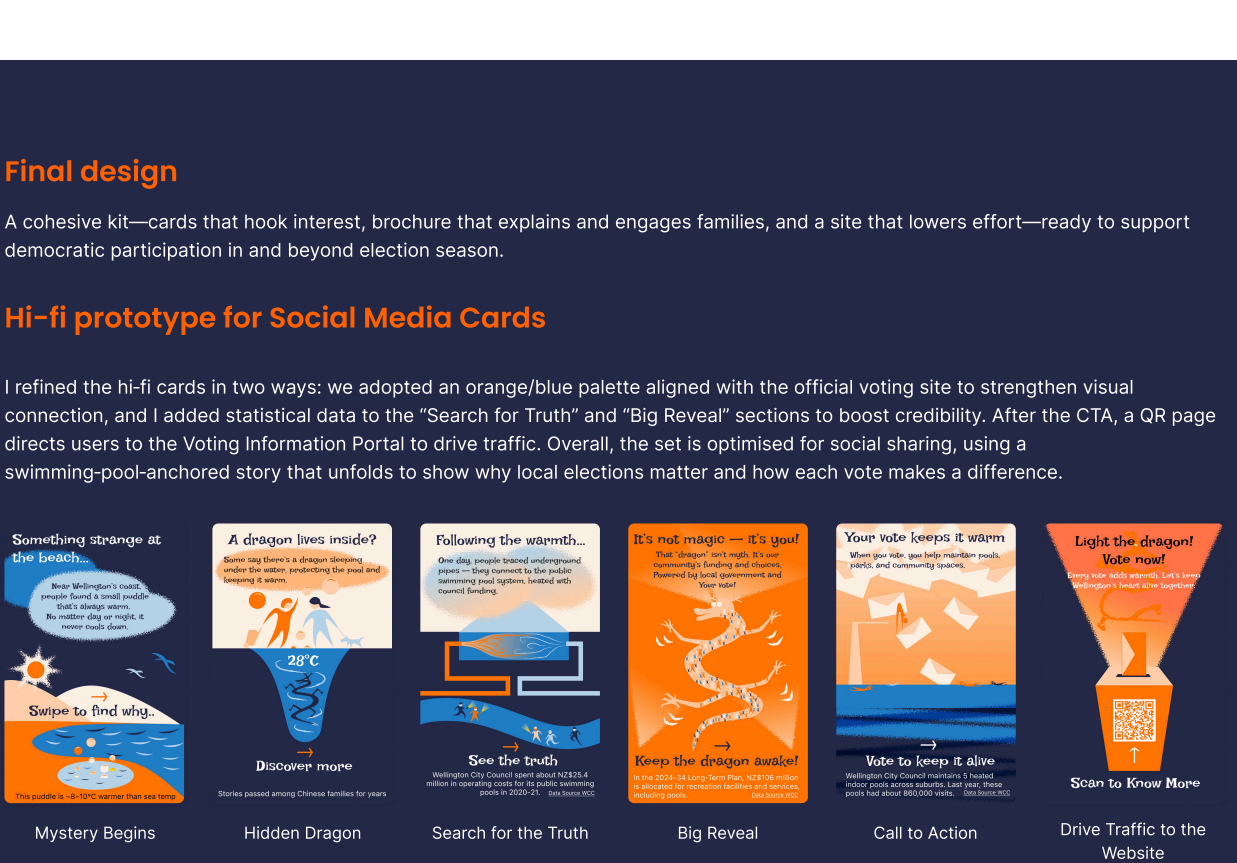
H1 Semi Bold 48px
H2 Semi Bold 32px
H3 Semi Bold 24px
Body Semi Bold 16px
Body Regular 16px

Final design

A cohesive kit—cards that hook interest, brochure that explains and engages families, and a site that lowers effort—ready to support democratic participation in and beyond election season.

Hi-fi prototype for Social Media Cards

I refined the hi-fi cards in two ways: we adopted an orange/blue palette aligned with the official voting site to strengthen visual connection, and I added statistical data to the "Search for Truth" and "Big Reveal" sections to boost credibility. After the CTA, a QR page directs users to the Voting Information Portal to drive traffic. Overall, the set is optimised for social sharing, using a swimming-pool-anchored story that unfolds to show why local elections matter and how each vote makes a difference.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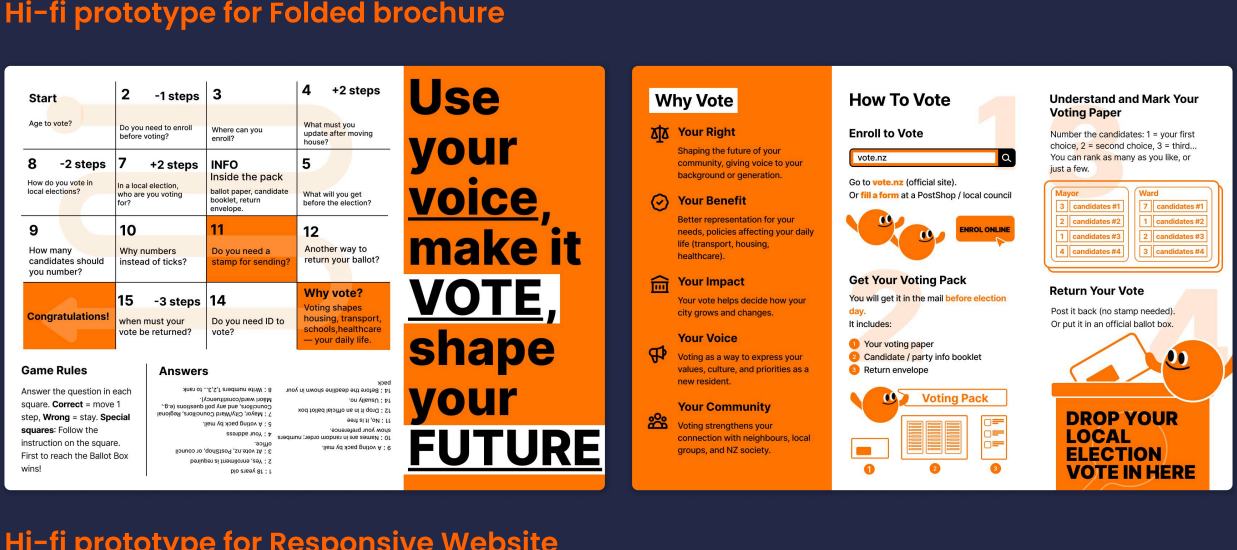
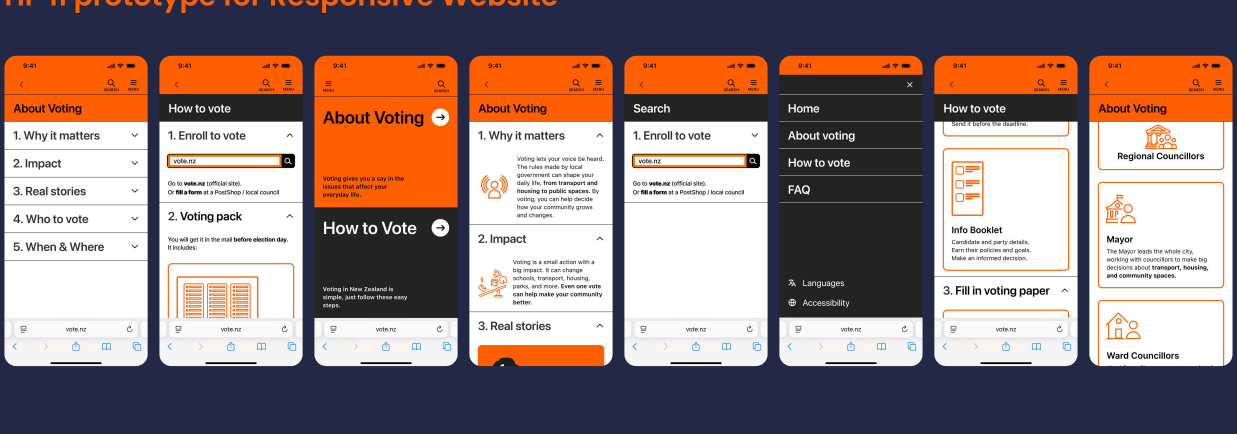
Mystery Begins · Hidden Dragon · Search for the Truth · Big Reveal · Call to Action · Drive Traffic to the Website

Hi-fi prototype for Folded brochure



Hi-fi prototype for Responsive Website



Retrospective

HENEX Method Recipe

Aim: Motivate and enable voting with plain, visual, social-first content—short actions, clear "why/how," simple paths.

Methods (short mapping):

- Why-First Data Story — Short, credible answers first (why/how).
- Small-Step Actions — Bite-sized interactions with clear CTAs.
- Mission-First Navigation — Flat IA: About Voting / How to Vote / Find Info.
- Clarity & Accessibility Audit — WCAG + simplified language for multilingual users.
- Step-by-Step Path Design — Four clear steps for "How to vote"; optional "know more."
- Peer Momentum Sharing — Friendly community tone, social proof in season.

Result: Users move from awareness → action—content is readable, trustworthy, and easy to follow.

Reflection

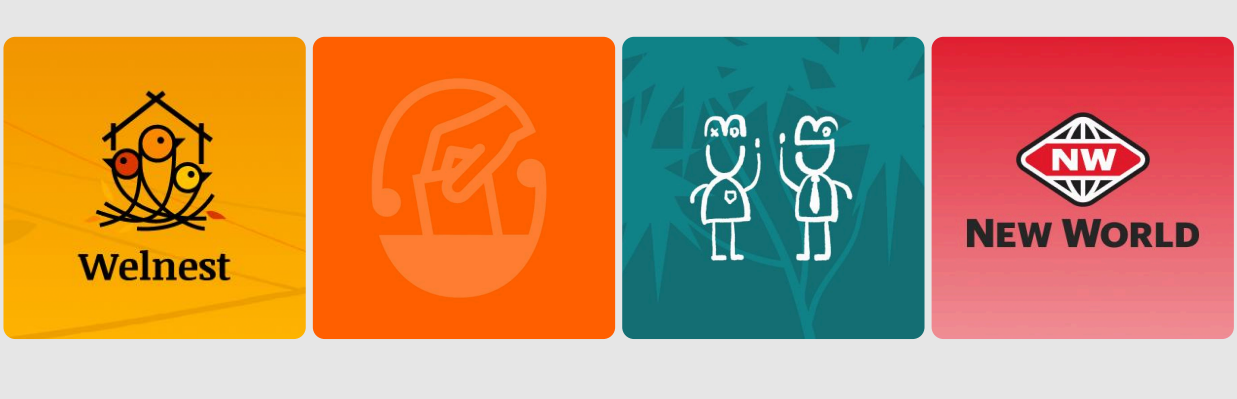
Cultural scope was narrow (few backgrounds), local civic experience was limited, evaluation lacked A/B and tree testing, and early empathy/journey artefacts were under-developed—making some definitions broad.

Next steps

Integrate empathy/journey mapping earlier, expand cultural range, add A/B and tree testing plus follow-up interviews, and keep iterating with real metrics and qualitative feedback to strengthen comprehension, confidence, and motivation across diverse groups.

View Prototype

Related Projects



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